he and Lashkar sympathizers in Oman discussed targeting prominent landmarks in Muscat, including the Golden Tulip Hotel and a British Broadcasting Corporation [BBC] office. No final plans were ever put in place, but the Omani authorities were able to gather enough evidence to convict al-Hooti in 2009.[47] His case illustrates the degree to which Lashkar's networks, intended primarily to support operations against India, could be used against other countries as well.

Al-Hooti's case was also part of a developing trend in which operatives pursued attacks against both Indian and foreign targets. Riyazuddin Nasir, alias Mohammad Ghouse, sought to blend the two by launching attacks in India that would kill Westerners, Jews and Indians. A resident of Hyderabad, India, Nasir is believed to have trained with Lashkar for 12–18 months between October 2005 and July 2007.[48] He belonged to a cell headed by Mohammad Abdul Shahid, one of the men recruited by the group in the wake of the Gujarat pogrom of 2002. The cell was linked to Lashkar and HuJI-B, on which it relied for logistical support.[49] As with the Indian Mujahideen, these men saw themselves as independent operators even though in reality their ability to function effectively without support from groups such as Lashkar or HuJI-B was limited. Nasir broke contact with his handlers in Pakistan soon after returning to India, and began planning a series of bomb attacks targeting American and Israeli tourists on Goa's crowded beaches over the Christmas-New Year period.[50] He and an accomplice later told police that, in addition to targeting Israeli and Western tourists, they also planed to strike against American and other foreign information technologies [IT] companies in Bangalore.[51] Nasir at one point claimed to an Indian journalist that he had discussed the Goa operation with Zaki-ur-Rehman Lakhvi, but Indian security officials believe he was acting independently of Lashkar by this time.[52] Nasir's case, to an even greater degree than al-Hooti's, highlights the degree to which the fight against India was overlapping with the global jihad by the latter half of the decade.

The emerging focus on foreign targets is notable, but we should not forget that Indians remained the ones dying by the hundreds in attacks perpetrated by their own countrymen. The bombing campaign, led by the Indian Mujahideen and supported by Lashkar operatives like al-Hooti, reached its apex from 2007–2008. Although the IM network had existed since the middle of the decade, it first announced its presence on 23